



Cricket shrine: The Cricket Club Cafe in Colombo is a treasure trove for lovers of the game, its rooms packed to the rafters with memorabilia from every corner of cricket's history. ABHISHEK SAINI

Cricket's curious habitats

Beyond the matches, our correspondents gather **vignettes** from the margins of the T20 World Cup.

Colombo 07 has plenty to brag about. Besides being the most affluent neighbourhood in the city, it is steeped in cricket history. Home to the Colombo Cricket Club, the Nondescripts Cricket Club and the grand old Sinhalese Sports Club (SSC), Maitland Place, the heart of

Colombo 07, has nurtured the sport for over a century. But a stone's throw from this pomp and show, Colombo 07 also has a place to quietly reminisce about cricket.

The Cricket Club Cafe, established in 1996 by an Australian couple, is still an infant compared to the hallowed venues that surround it. But it is no less capable of taking you down

memory lane.

For a cricket nut such as the Diary, it is a treat. If one is inclined to take note of the memorabilia on its walls, it is easy to lose count. Sachin Tendulkar finds space here multiple times, in fact. As do Sir Garfield Sobers, Wasim Akram, Brian Lara and Shane Warne.

There is an entire section dedicated to Sir Don Bradman, comprising nearly century-old newspaper clippings, portraits, hand-drawn sketches and even his